

Ekaterina (Kate) Volkova

CONTACT INFORMATION	<i>E-mail:</i> evolkova@unimelb.edu.au <i>Homepage:</i> www.evolkova.info <i>Google Scholar:</i> scholar.google.com/citations?user=XXLvYR4AAAAJ <i>SSRN:</i> ssrn.com/author=2535036 <i>Address:</i> 11.048, 198 Berkeley Street, Parkville, 3053, Australia		
ACADEMIC POSITION	Finance Department, The University of Melbourne		
	Associate Professor		2024 – present
	Assistant Dean (Graduate Research)		2025 – present
	Senior Lecturer (Assistant Professor)		2017 – 2023
EDUCATION	SC Johnson College of Business, Cornell University, PhD, Finance 2017 New Economic School, MA, Economics 2012 Moscow State University, MS, Mathematics <i>summa cum laude</i> 2011		
PUBLICATIONS	Antitrust Enforcement Increases Economic Activity , with Tania Babina, Simcha Barkai, Jessica Jeffers, and Ezra Karger <i>Conditionally Accepted, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics</i> Regulatory Fragmentation , with Joseph Kalmenovitz and Michelle Lowry <i>The Journal of Finance, 2025, <u>Brattle Group Prize (Distinguished Paper)</u></i> Is Blockholder Diversity Detrimental? with Miriam Schwartz-Ziv <i>Management Science, 2025</i> Information Revelation Through Regulatory Process: Interactions between the SEC and Companies Ahead of the IPO , with Michelle Lowry and Roni Michaely <i>The Review of Financial Studies, 2020</i> Watch Your Basket – to Determine CEO Compensation , with Neal Galpin, Hae Won (Henny) Jung, and Lyndon Moore <i>Financial Management, 2019</i> Can VPIN Forecast Geopolitical Events? An Application to the Crimean Crisis , with Felipe Silva <i>Annals of Finance, 2018</i>		
REVIEW CHAPTERS	Initial Public Offering: A Synthesis of the Literature and Directions for Future Research , with Michelle Lowry and Roni Michaely <i>Foundation and Trends® in Finance, 2017</i>		
EVENT STUDIES	When deregulation wins: Cross-sectional evidence from the 2024 Trump election with Alan Kwan and Cagri Onuk <i>Finance Research Letters, 2026</i> Media Ownership and Ideological Slant: Evidence from Australian Newspaper Mergers , with Maxim Ananyev <i>PLOS One, 2024</i>		
WORKING PAPERS	Lobbying Congress versus Agencies , with Michelle Lowry Revise and Resubmit , <i>The Journal of Finance</i>		

Him Too? Analyzing the Effects of Epstein Connections, with Marina Gertsberg and Michaela Pagel
CEPR Discussion Paper 21352; CESifo Working Paper 12580

AWARDS & PRIZES	Brattle Group Prize (Distinguished Paper) 2025 <i>The Journal of Finance</i> , for “Regulatory Fragmentation”
	Best Paper Award, VICIF 2026 for “Him Too? Analyzing the Effects of Epstein Connections”
	Best Paper Award, Lake District Workshop in Corporate Finance 2026 for “Lobbying Congress versus Agencies”
	The Brattle Group FIRN Best Paper Award 2024 for “Antitrust Enforcement Increases Economic Activity”
	Best Paper Award, CAFM Conference 2023 for “Regulatory Fragmentation”
	Best Paper Award, FMARC Conference 2023 for “Regulatory Fragmentation”
	Cynthia Hardy Award for Research Impact, University of Melbourne 2023
DATA	Block Ownership: all blockholders holding at least 5% of US public companies, 1998–2025. Available via WRDS and my website .
	Regulatory Fragmentation: firm-level Regulatory Fragmentation, Topic Dispersion, and Regulation Quantity for all US public firms, 1995–2025. Available on my website .
	Rule Relatedness: company-specific rule relatedness for all proposed and final SEC rules, 1999–2023. Available on my website .
POLICY IMPACT	<i>Research cited in U.S. federal rulemakings</i> Regulatory Fragmentation: U.S. Department of the Treasury (FinCEN), Proposed Rule on AML/CFT Requirements for Investment Advisers , 90 Fed. Reg. 45361 (2025) Information Revelation Through Regulatory Process: U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission, Special Purpose Acquisition Companies, Shell Companies, and Projections , Proposed Rule, 87 Fed. Reg. 29458 (2022) Initial Public Offering: A Synthesis of the Literature: U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission, Solicitations of Interest Prior to a Registered Public Offering, Proposed Rule , 84 Fed. Reg. 6713 (2019), and Final Rule , 84 Fed. Reg. 53011 (2019)
PRESENTATIONS & CONFERENCES	<i>The list includes scheduled, online and by coauthors</i> 2027: AFA (expected); AEA (expected) 2026: Finance Down Under; 4th HKU Summer Finance Conference, Hong Kong; UEBS Edinburgh Corporate Finance; Lake District Workshop in Corporate Finance; FMA Europe, Braga, Portugal; CICF; VICIF 2026; NBER SI Corporate Finance; NUS RMI 19th Risk Management Conference, Singapore; EFA; Australian Competition and Consumer Commission; University of Auckland; University of Queensland; Strathclyde University

2025: Finance Down Under; 7th Future of Financial Information Conference; FIRS; Erasmus Corporate Governance Conference; EFMA; Global PhD Student Colloquium; Third Aarhus Workshop on Strategic Interaction in Corporate Finance; EFA; Politics in Finance; FMA Asia; Monash University

2024: Adam Smith Workshop, London, UK; HKU Summer Finance Workshop, Hong Kong; NBER SI; FIRN Annual, Port Douglas, Australia; SBFC, Sydney Australia; Deakin University; University of Essex

2023: AFA, New Orleans; AEA New Orleans; Boston College; The Department of Justice, Antitrust Division; NBER SI; FMARC, Cyprus

2022: Financial Research Network (FIRN); Copenhagen Business School; the Federal Reserve; George Mason University; University of Rochester; University of Toronto; University of Melbourne; University of Washington; Wayne State University; Florida International University; University of Bath; University of Bristol

2021: University of Melbourne; Asia-Pacific Corporate Finance Online Workshop; FIRN Women Conference; the Future of Financial Information Conference; APRCF Conference

2020: FIRN seminar; University of Melbourne; Asia-Pacific Corporate Finance Online Workshop

2019: Summer Finance Conference, Hebrew University, Jerusalem, Israel; University of Technology, Sydney, Australia; Queensland Corporate Finance Conference, Brisbane, Australia

2018: AFA, Philadelphia; University of New South Wales, Sydney; Australian National University, Canberra; Office of the Comptroller of the Currency, Washington; Fifth Annual Conference of Financial Market Regulations at the SEC, Washington; Executive Compensation Conference in Rotterdam, Netherlands; FIRN Annual Meeting, Brisbane, Australia; FMA, San Diego, USA

2017: PPMC, Paris, France; FMA, Boston, USA; Frontiers of Finance, London, UK; Hong Kong University, Hong Kong; University of Melbourne, Melbourne, Australia; Copenhagen Business School, Copenhagen, Denmark; Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI, USA; London Business School, London, UK; New Economic School, Moscow, Russia; Higher School of Economics, Moscow, Russia; Emory University, Atlanta, GA, USA

2016: Cornell University, Ithaca, NY, USA; Binghamton University, Binghamton, NY, USA; New Economic School, Moscow, Russia; Higher School of Economics, Moscow, Russia

2015: STRATA Big Data, New York, USA

2014: Queen's University, Kingston, Canada

POLICY WRITING [How businesses with ties to Jeffrey Epstein saw norms and share prices suffer](#)
The Conversation

[Him Too? The Corporate Consequences of Epstein Connections](#)
Oxford Business Law Blog

[Corporate Lobbying of Executive Agencies](#)
CLS Blue Sky Blog, Columbia Law School

[Antitrust Enforcement Increases Economic Activity](#)
ProMarket, Stigler Center, University of Chicago

[The Government Agenda and the Effects of Regulatory Dispersion](#)
The FinReg Blog, Duke University School of Law

	Initial Public Offering: A Synthesis of the Literature <i>Oxford Business Law Blog</i>	
MEDIA COVERAGE & PODCASTS	<i>Him Too?:</i> Salon , Klement on Investing <i>Regulatory Fragmentation:</i> Marginal Revolution , HKU Jockey Club ESGRI (feature and podcast), Drexel LeBow News <i>Lobbying Congress versus Agencies:</i> HKU Business School <i>Antitrust Enforcement:</i> The Brattle Exchange (podcast) <i>VPIN and the Crimean Crisis:</i> Bloomberg , Washington Post , Radio Free Europe , Vedomosti , Der Standard , InfoMoney	
GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIPS	AFAANZ Research Grant 2026 ARC Support Grant (DECRA Seed), FBE, University of Melbourne 2025 CALIBER FBE Research Lab, University of Melbourne 2025 ARC Support Grant (DECRA Seed), FBE, University of Melbourne 2024 Early Career Research Grant, University of Melbourne 2021 FBE Research Grant, University of Melbourne 2021 Early Career Research Grant, FBE, University of Melbourne 2020 AFAANZ Research Grant 2020 Student Travel Grant for AFA Annual Meeting 2016 Anna S. Dvornikova and Ilya A. Strebulaev Fund 2012 BP Scholarship 2010–2012 New Economic School Academic Scholarship 2011–2012 Moscow State University Academic Scholarship 2006–2011	
PROFESSIONAL SERVICE	<i>Referee:</i> The Quarterly Journal of Economics ; The Review of Financial Studies ; Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis ; Review of Finance ; Management Science ; Review of Corporate Finance Studies ; Journal of Banking and Finance ; Journal of Corporate Finance ; Financial Review ; Journal of Regulatory Economics	
PHD SUPERVISION	<i>Completed candidates and first placement</i> Phuong Lan Nguyen, University of Adelaide 2020 Yifan Zhou, Fudan University 2021 Muhan Hu, University of Strathclyde 2023 Sheng Huang, Jinan University 2023 Grace Meng, Southwestern University 2023 Stephen Dixon (in progress) expected 2026	
WORKSHOPS	Summer School in Financial Intermediation and Contracting, WashU 2015 Yale Summer School in Behavioral Finance 2013	
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	<i>Research Fellow, Research Laboratory for Strategic Behavior and Institutional Design, Moscow</i> 2011 – 2012 <i>Research Fellow, Yandex, Moscow</i> 2011	
PERSONAL INFORMATION	Married with one child (born in 2022); Australian and Russian citizenship <i>Last updated: September 2026</i>	